

DPDP Compliance Guidance Generator

— Phase 1 Overview

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DPDP Compliance Guidance Generator

Phase 1 — Project Overview & Technical Documentation

Product: DPDP Compliance Guidance Generator

Version: 1.0 (Phase 1 MVP)

Document type: Executive & technical overview

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Classification: For external sharing

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1. Executive summary

The **DPDP Compliance Guidance Generator** is a web application that helps Indian small and medium enterprises (SMEs) understand their obligations under the **Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023** and **DPDP Rules, 2025**.

A business completes a structured questionnaire about its data practices and receives a **personalized compliance gap report** — identifying which obligations apply, where gaps exist, and a prioritized action plan aligned to regulatory deadlines (November 2026 and May 2027).

The system uses **deterministic rule-based scoring** grounded in official legal source documents that users can download and verify. Compliance status is **not** decided by an AI language model, ensuring reproducible and auditable results.

2. Problem statement

The problem

Indian businesses — particularly SMEs in hospitality, retail, healthcare, D2C, and related sectors — are subject to the DPDP Act and Rules, with a hard compliance deadline of **May 13, 2027**. However:

- Most are **unaware** the law applies to them
- Even when aware, they lack **legal expertise, time, or budget** to interpret dense legal text
- Generic blog content does not tell them what **they specifically** need to do
- Hiring lawyers or consultants is **expensive and slow** relative to business scale
- Doing nothing exposes them to **penalties and breach risk**

What Phase 1 solves

A business answers a structured questionnaire and receives a **personalized, legally-grounded compliance gap report** — without reading the Act themselves or hiring a consultant for initial orientation.

Success criterion

A business owner with **zero prior DPDP awareness** (e.g. a hotel operator) can, in a few minutes, understand:

- What applies to them
- Where they fall short today
- What to fix first and by when

Phase 1 vs Phase 2

Phase	Question answered
Phase 1 (this product)	What do I need to do and why?
Phase 2 (planned)	How do I actually do it every day? (consent management, data inventory, breach workflows)

3. Solution overview

The application combines three layers:

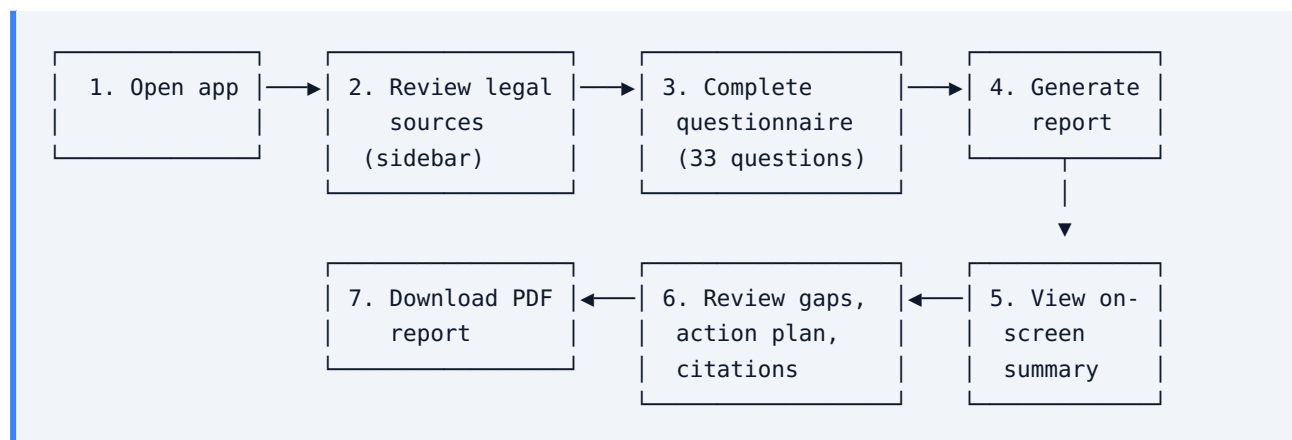
1. **Structured intake** — 33 questions across 9 sections about data practices

2. **Rules engine** — 39 DPDP obligations scored as Met / Partially met / Not met / Not applicable
3. **Legal grounding** — Official Act and Rules PDFs with keyword-based citation retrieval

Design principle: Scoring is deterministic and auditable. Legal PDFs are the source of truth. Users can download sources to verify any recommendation.

4. End-to-end user workflow

This is the complete journey from a business user’s perspective:



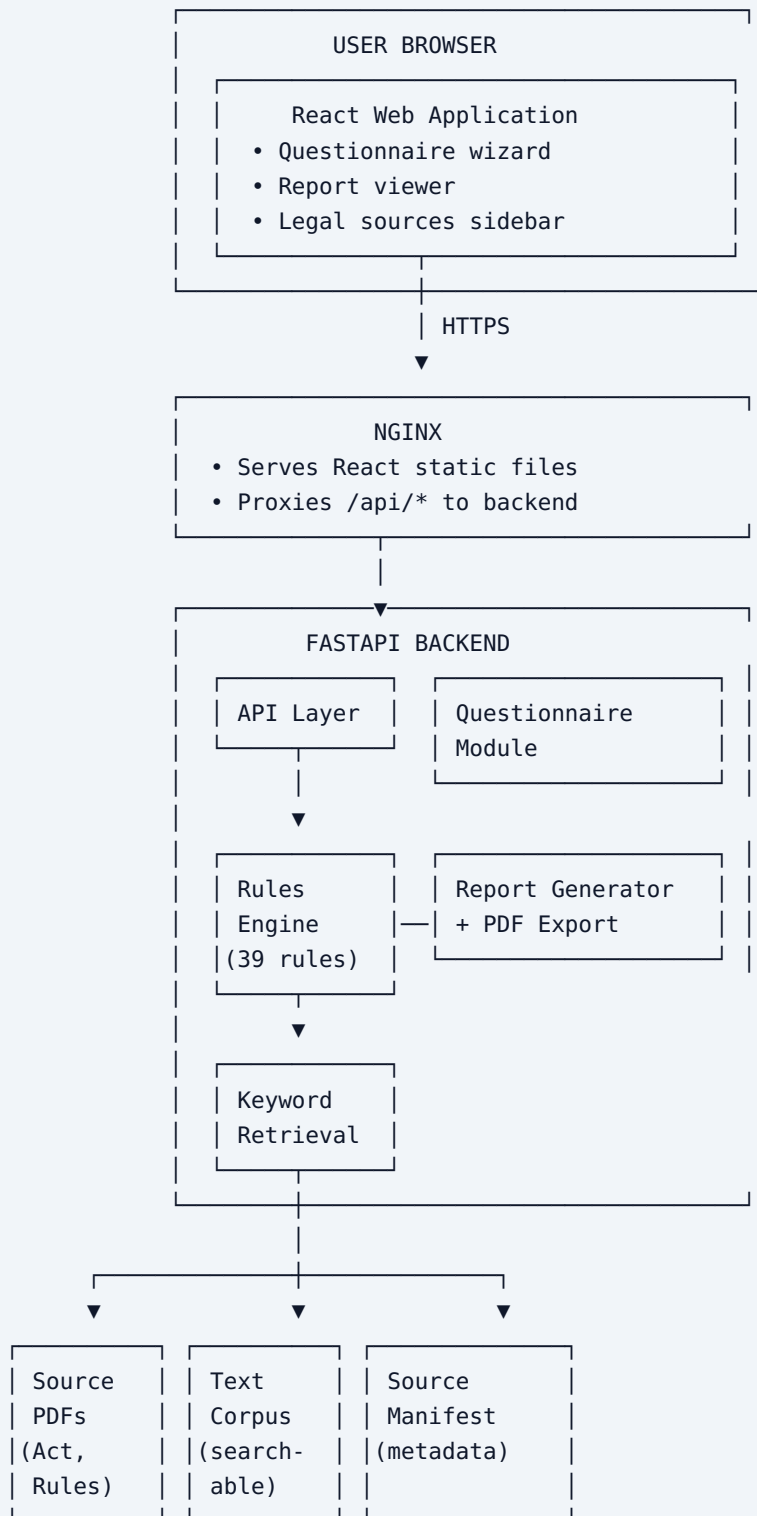
Step-by-step

Step	User action	System response
1	Opens the web application	Landing page with legal sources sidebar
2	Optionally downloads source PDFs	Official DPDP Act, Rules, and reference documents
3	Enters company name, sector, answers questionnaire	Questions grouped by topic (data collection, consent, security, etc.)
4	Clicks “Generate gap report”	Backend scores all 39 obligations
5	Reviews on-screen report	Summary, timeline, action plan, obligation details with citations
6	Verifies citations against source PDFs	Download links per obligation
7	Downloads PDF report	Professional PDF for printing, email, or internal sharing

Typical duration: 15–25 minutes for a first-time user.

5. System architecture

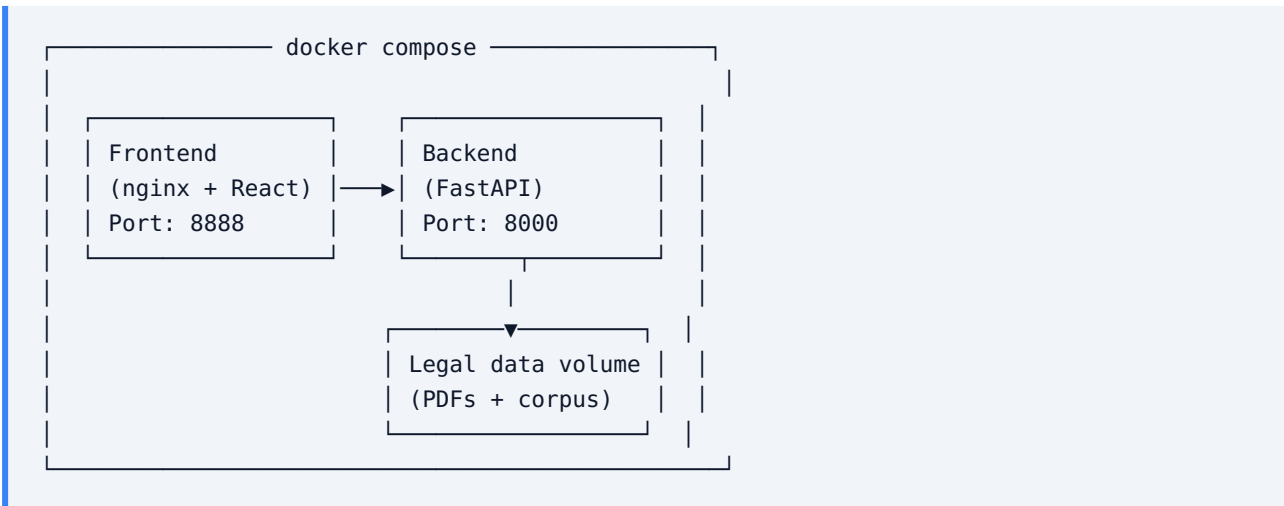
High-level architecture diagram



Component responsibilities

Component	Responsibility
React frontend	Questionnaire wizard, report view, legal sources sidebar, PDF download
nginx	Single entry point; serves UI and proxies API requests
FastAPI backend	REST API, request validation, orchestration
Rules engine	Maps questionnaire answers to obligation statuses (deterministic)
Retrieval layer	Keyword search over legal text corpus for citations
PDF export	Professional gap report generation
Legal data store	Official DPDP Act and Rules PDFs with metadata catalog

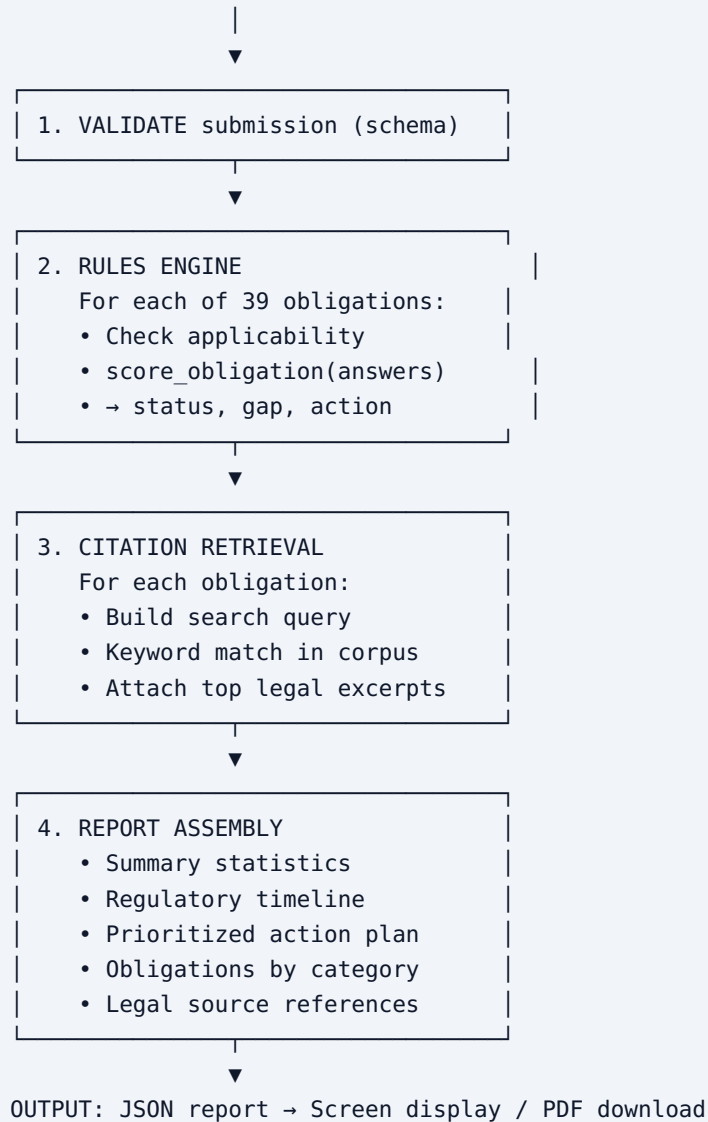
Deployment topology (Docker)



6. Technical workflow (backend processing)

When a user submits the questionnaire, the following processing occurs:

INPUT: company_name, sector, answers{33 fields}



Scoring approach

Approach	Used for	Rationale
Rule-based logic	Met / Partial / Not met decisions	Reproducible, auditable, no hallucination
Keyword retrieval	Legal excerpts and citations	Grounded in actual Act/Rules text
LLM (not used)	—	Avoided for compliance decisions in Phase 1

7. Regulatory context

DPDP Act, 2023

India's standalone data protection law (Act No. 22 of 2023), published August 11, 2023.

Key roles:

- **Data Principal** — individual whose data is processed
- **Data Fiduciary** — entity deciding purpose and means of processing
- **Data Processor** — processes on fiduciary's behalf
- **Significant Data Fiduciary (SDF)** — designated by government for enhanced obligations

DPDP Rules, 2025

Notified November 13, 2025 (G.S.R. 846(E)).

Implementation timeline

Phase	Effective date	What kicks in
Phase I	Nov 13, 2025	Data Protection Board established
Phase II	Nov 13, 2026	Consent Manager provisions
Phase III	May 13, 2027	All substantive compliance obligations

Primary legal sources (embedded in application)

Document	Role
DPDP Act, 2023 (MeitY)	Primary legal text
DPDP Rules, 2025 (G.S.R. 846(E))	Operational rules
PIB notification summary	Implementation timeline
DSCI Rule-to-Section index	Cross-reference
DLA Piper India guide	Secondary interpretation reference

All primary sources are downloadable from within the application for instant verification.

8. Product scope

In scope (Phase 1)

- Structured questionnaire (33 questions, 9 sections)
- Assessment of **39 Data Fiduciary obligations**
- Status per obligation: Met / Partially met / Not met / Not applicable
- Keyword-based legal excerpt retrieval for citations
- Downloadable primary source PDFs from the application
- Prioritized action plan (Nov 2026 vs May 2027 deadlines)
- Professional PDF gap report download
- Containerized deployment for demos and pilots

Out of scope (Phase 1)

- AI/LLM-based compliance decisions
 - Drafting legal documents (privacy policies, DPAs)
 - Ongoing consent management or monitoring
 - Integration with customer systems (CRM, PMS, website)
 - Multi-tenant SaaS with user accounts
 - Certified legal opinions
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9. Target users and sectors

Users

User	Need
SME business owner	Understand DPDP applicability and gaps quickly
Operations / IT manager	Actionable checklist before May 2027
Internal compliance champion	Structured starting point
CEO / leadership	Executive summary for decision-making

Supported sectors (23)

Hospitality, retail, healthcare, D2C, food & beverage, travel, fintech, insurance, education, real estate, logistics, manufacturing, IT/SaaS, professional services, media, automotive, telecom, agriculture, nonprofit, staffing, beauty/wellness, fitness, and other.

10. Questionnaire and obligation engine

Questionnaire sections (9)

1. Business profile
2. Data collection
3. Notice & consent
4. Data lifecycle
5. Data Principal rights
6. Transparency & contact
7. Processors & transfers
8. Security & breach
9. Employment & Significant Data Fiduciary

Obligation categories (39 total)

Category	Count	Examples
Lawful processing	4	Consent, legitimate use, purpose limitation
Notice & consent	6	Rule 3 notice, consent records, withdrawal
Data quality & lifecycle	4	Accuracy, retention, erasure
Data Principal rights	6	Access, correction, erasure, grievance
Transparency & contact	2	DPO contact, grievance officer
Processors & transfers	3	Contracts, oversight, cross-border
Security & breach	5	Safeguards, logging, breach notification
Children's data	2	Verifiable consent, no tracking
SDF / special cases	7	SDF assessment, employee data, CCTV

Status definitions

Status	Meaning
Met	Reported practice satisfies obligation
Partially met	Some elements present; gaps remain
Not met	Material gap; action required
Not applicable	Does not apply based on answers

11. Legal knowledge base

How legal grounding works

1. Official DPDP Act and Rules PDFs are stored in the application
2. Text is extracted and split into searchable segments
3. When scoring an obligation, relevant segments are retrieved by keyword matching
4. Excerpts are attached to the report with links to download the full source PDF

Why this matters for trust

Users can verify every recommendation against the original legal text — critical for a compliance product aimed at businesses without in-house legal teams.

12. Report output

On-screen report includes

- Executive summary (obligations assessed, gaps found, critical gaps)
- Regulatory timeline with key dates
- Prioritized action plan (before Nov 2026 / before May 2027)
- Detailed obligation assessment grouped by category
- Legal excerpts with source download links

PDF report includes

- Professional cover page (company name, sector, IST timestamp)
 - Page numbers
 - Print-ready layout for sharing with stakeholders
 - Full disclaimer
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13. Technology stack

Layer	Technology
Frontend	React 18, TypeScript, Vite
API server	Python 3.11, FastAPI, Uvicorn
Scoring	Deterministic Python rules engine
Legal retrieval	Keyword search over indexed corpus
PDF generation	WeasyPrint
Reverse proxy	nginx
Packaging	Docker, Docker Compose

14. Deployment model

The application runs as two containerized services:

- **Frontend container** — nginx serving the React app on port 8888
- **Backend container** — FastAPI API with legal data volume mounted

Single URL access for demos and presentations. Suitable for on-premise pilot, private cloud, or internal network deployment.

15. Security and privacy

- Stateless API — no questionnaire data persisted to database in v1
 - Legal source PDFs mounted read-only
 - No authentication in v1 — intended for private/demo deployment
 - CORS restricted to application origin
 - Suitable for deployment behind corporate VPN or private network
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16. Limitations and disclaimers

Limitations

1. **Self-reported answers** — report accuracy depends on honest input
2. **Rule-based interpretation** — not a substitute for qualified legal counsel
3. **Keyword citations** — excerpts support verification but should be cross-checked
4. **Sector selection** — labels the business; scoring logic is largely sector-agnostic in v1
5. **SDF status** — heuristic assessment only; government designates Significant Data Fiduciaries

Disclaimer

This report is automated compliance guidance based on questionnaire answers and the DPDP Act 2023 / DPDP Rules 2025. It is not legal advice. Download and verify the cited source documents. Consult qualified counsel before relying on this report for regulatory decisions.

17. Product roadmap

Phase	Capability	Status
Phase 1	Gap assessment + action plan + PDF report	Complete
Phase 2a	Auto-draft privacy notices, DPAs, consent copy	Planned
Phase 2b	Consent management, data inventory, rights workflows	Planned
Phase 3	Full compliance operating system with integrations	Planned

Phase 1 questionnaire data is structured to seed Phase 2 without requiring businesses to re-enter information.

Document information

Field	Value
Title	DPDP Compliance Guidance Generator — Phase 1 Overview
Version	1.0
Date	July 2026
Purpose	Executive and technical sharing

End of document